

Resit coursework 2025

1. [5 marks] What are the Fourier coefficients c_k of $\sin^4 x$?
2. [5 marks] Show for $0 \leq k, \ell \leq n-1$

$$\frac{1}{n} \sum_{j=1}^n \cos k\theta_j \cos \ell\theta_j = \begin{cases} 1 & k = \ell = 0 \\ 1/2 & k = \ell \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

for $\theta_j = \pi(j-1/2)/n$. Hint: You may consider replacing $\cos$ with complex exponentials:

$$\cos \theta = \frac{e^{i\theta} + e^{-i\theta}}{2}.$$

3. [5 marks] Consider the Discrete Cosine Transform (DCT)

$$C_n := \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{1/n} & & & \\ & \sqrt{2/n} & & \\ & & \ddots & \\ & & & \sqrt{2/n} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \cdots & 1 \\ \cos \theta_1 & \cdots & \cos \theta_n \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ \cos(n-1)\theta_1 & \cdots & \cos(n-1)\theta_n \end{bmatrix}$$

for $\theta_j = \pi(j-1/2)/n$. Prove that C_n is orthogonal: $C_n^\top C_n = C_n C_n^\top = I$. Hint: $C_n C_n^\top = I$ might be easier to show than $C_n^\top C_n = I$ using the previous problem.

4. [10 marks] Consider the variable-coefficient advection equation

$$u_t + c(x)u_x = 0, \quad c(x) = \frac{1}{5} + \sin^2(x-1), \quad x \in [0, 2\pi), \quad t \in [0, T],$$

with $u(x, 0) = f(x) = e^{-100(x-1)^2}$, which we approximate with the leapfrog method

$$\mathbf{u}^{i+1} = \mathbf{u}^{i-1} - 2\tau c(\mathbf{x}) \cdot \mathcal{F}^{-1} \left\{ i(-m:m) \cdot \mathcal{F}\{\mathbf{u}^i\} \right\}, \quad i = 0, \dots, n_t - 1.$$

Note that one needs $\mathbf{u}^{-1}$ to initialise the leapfrog method. Let the entries of $\mathbf{u}^{-1}$ be $u_j^{-1} = f(x_j + \tau/5)$, $j = 0, \dots, n_x - 1$. The exact solution is periodic in time, i.e.,

$$u(x, t + T) = u(x, t)$$

where

$$T = \int_0^{2\pi} \frac{1}{c(x)} dx = 12.8254983016186 \dots$$

Compute T using the Trapezoidal rule and confirm that you get the value stated above. Then compute

$$e(n_x) = \max_{j=0, \dots, n_x-1} |u_j^0 - u_j^{n_t}|$$

where $n_t = 8n_x$ and $\tau n_t = T$ and plot $e(n_x)$ for $n_x = 2^k + 1$, with $k = 5, 6, \dots, 10$. Comment on the behaviour of $e(n_x)$.

The (well-posed) convection-diffusion equation is

$$\frac{\partial u}{\partial t} = \frac{\partial^2 u}{\partial x^2} - b \frac{\partial u}{\partial x}, \quad 0 \leq x \leq 1, \quad 0 \leq t \leq T, \quad T > 0,$$

where $b > 0$ is given (a constant) and the boundary conditions are $u(0, t) = \varphi_0(t)$ and $u(1, t) = \varphi_1(t)$ for $t \in [0, T]$. Let

$$v'_j = \frac{1}{h^2} (v_{j-1} - 2v_j + v_{j+1}) - \frac{b}{2h} (v_{j+1} - v_{j-1}), \quad j = 1, 2, \dots, n_x,$$

where $h = \frac{1}{n_x + 1}$ and $v_j = v_j(t)$ be a semi-discrete method for the convection-diffusion equation.

5. **[5 marks]** Prove that the semi-discrete method is second-order accurate. That is, let $\tilde{v}_j(t) = u(x_j, t)$ and show that (assuming all the relevant partial derivatives are bounded on $(x, t) \in [0, 1] \times [0, T]$),

$$\tilde{v}'_j - \frac{1}{h^2} (\tilde{v}_{j-1} - 2\tilde{v}_j + \tilde{v}_{j+1}) + \frac{b}{2h} (\tilde{v}_{j+1} - \tilde{v}_{j-1}) = \mathcal{O}(h^2), \quad h \rightarrow 0.$$

6. **[2 marks]** Is the semi-discrete method consistent? Motivate your answer.
7. **[6 marks]** Use the von Neumann method to determine whether the semi-discrete method is stable.
8. **[2 marks]** Is the semi-discrete method convergent? Motivate your answer.
9. **[5 marks]** Show that the semi-discrete method can be expressed as the following system of ordinary differential equations (ODEs):

$$\mathbf{v}' = A\mathbf{v} + \mathbf{h}$$

with $\mathbf{v}, \mathbf{h} \in \mathbb{R}^{n_x}$, $A \in \mathbb{R}^{n_x \times n_x}$ where

$$A = \frac{1}{h^2} \begin{bmatrix} -2 & 1 - \frac{bh}{2} & & & \\ 1 + \frac{bh}{2} & -2 & 1 - \frac{bh}{2} & & \\ & \ddots & \ddots & \ddots & \\ & & 1 + \frac{bh}{2} & -2 & 1 - \frac{bh}{2} \\ & & & 1 + \frac{bh}{2} & -2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{h} = \frac{1}{h^2} \begin{bmatrix} \left(1 + \frac{bh}{2}\right) \varphi_0(t) \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ \left(1 - \frac{bh}{2}\right) \varphi_1(t) \end{bmatrix}.$$

6. **[10 marks]** Let $n_x = 300$, $T = 0.003$, $b = 100$, $\varphi_0(t) = 0 = \varphi_1(t)$ and $u(x, 0) = e^{-300(x-0.3)^2}$, then solve the ODE system in question 5 with an error tolerance of 10^{-4} using any ODE solver that's available in your programming language of choice. Plot the solution at $t = 0$ and $t = T$ on the same set of axes.